

- Is this piece ART or CRAFT? Is it perhaps BOTH?

This Irises painting is both art and craft. It is an art because Van Gogh used his imagination and his emotional experience painting from inside an asylum garden to express something deeply personal. It is also craft because of the extraordinary skill visible in every inch of the canvas, the thick impasto brushwork, the individual attention given to each petal and stem, and the deliberate use of color contrast between the blue violet irises and the warm orange background flowers.

- What about this selection drew you to it or caught your eye?

When walking in the Getty Museum, I just happened to see this work and it really caught my attention. When looking at this painting the one pale iris in the painting of full blue irises really caught my attention.

- What kinds of *feelings* does the piece elicit when you see it?

When looking at this work at first I feel like it shows joy and melancholy. The colors feel alive and celebratory, but knowing the context changes everything. Van Gogh painted this after voluntarily committing himself to the Saint Paul de Mausole asylum following a mental health crisis where he cut off his own ear.

- What do you think the artist is trying to say with the piece?

I think Van Gogh is saying that you can find beauty anywhere if you are willing to look for it, even from inside the walls of an institution. He also conveys a deep sense of isolation through that single white iris surrounded by blue ones.

- What does the piece say to YOU personally regardless of what the artist is saying?

Personally, the painting tells me that being different from everyone around you is not a flaw, it may be exactly what makes you remarkable. The white iris does not ruin the painting, but it is what makes the painting more complete.

- Do you think Artificial Intelligence could produce something of equal meaning?

I feel like the AI right now, it may produce some work that has equal meaning if we say the prompt and our meaning, but it will not replicate the work exactly the same. As far as I know, the AI generation may be good but it cannot duplicate the work 100% completely, usually it missed the small detail in the work. AI work also feels empty as if the work does not contain any soul in it.

- How do you think you might apply the concept of art or craft to your software designs and coding?

I think I can apply the craft as it is the skill to handle problems in coding (problem solving) and art is the way of coding that may differ from other people like comment style and indentation.

- Do you think software creation SHOULD BE an art? Should it be a craft?

Software creation should be both. Craft ensures it works reliably. Art ensures it communicates clearly and that the people who come after you can understand and build on what you made. Code that only works but is impossible to read is like a technically perfect painting that no one wants to look at.

- What kinds of questions do you ask yourself about your design/code? Do you go back to it after it is working and re-factor it to make it *clean*?

After my code is working, I go back and clean it by removing unnecessary lines and comments. I do this because clean code is easier for teammates and my future self to read.

